

hELL

One word. One lie. One truth.

FINAL STORY ARC

By Thor Fabian Pettersen

One word. One lie. One truth.

1. The impossible encounter

Demonic Lucifer rises from Hell at the head of its hordes, determined to conquer Heaven. At the celestial court, he encounters Michael, radiant and armed. Another angel stands beside Michael, watching with a quiet, serpentine smile.

Lucifer stops in complete shock. Michael's presence seems impossible. The audience does not yet know why.

Their battle begins. Lucifer is powerful enough to win, but as the confrontation unfolds, his shock gives way to a recognition we cannot yet understand. At the decisive moment, he withholds the blow that could defeat Michael.

"We are the same, you and I..."

Michael misunderstands. Lucifer allows him to strike and is cast into the abyss. We remain with Michael as the demonic figure disappears below.

2. The victory Michael cannot believe

Heaven celebrates. The angels believe Michael has proved himself stronger than Lucifer and saved them from destruction. Michael knows that Lucifer could have won. He cannot explain why his enemy surrendered or what he meant by his final words.

Time passes. Suffering spreads through the mortal realms, and reports suggest that Lucifer is gathering strength again. Michael fears that another war will bring devastation to innocent beings. His unexplained victory makes him doubt that the danger was ever contained.

Gabriel insists that God's prohibition must stand: no angel may descend into Hell. Michael seeks guidance from God but receives no answer that resolves the suffering before him. He concludes that he must confront Lucifer again and finish what he believes he left unfinished.

3. The forbidden descent

Gabriel has fortified the place where Lucifer fell, sealing the route into the abyss. Michael approaches through the forbidden realm above Heaven, reaching the barrier from beyond the ground Gabriel guards. The Watchers let him pass, sharing his hope that the suffering can be ended.

Michael descends against God's command. He accepts the danger because he believes Lucifer is the cause of creation's torment. His purpose is to protect the beings he loves, even if obedience and his own safety must be sacrificed.

His descent echoes Lucifer's fall. Heaven loses the defender who has just saved it.

4. The enemy in the ice

At Hell's deepest point, Michael finds a frozen realm of darkness and silence. There he confronts Lucifer, whose monstrous form seems bound to the ice itself.

The demon behaves like a shadow or distorted reflection. He knows Michael's movements and fears, and seems to have expected his arrival. Their confrontation appears to be a battle, but its strangeness grows with every exchange.

Michael delivers what he believes is the final blow. The figure before him breaks apart and disappears. Nothing is liberated. Hell remains.

As Michael looks into the ice, his own appearance begins to change. He recognizes the face, wounds, and demonic form of the being he came to destroy. The apparent battle has carried him into Lucifer's place. There was no independent enemy whose destruction could end his suffering. He understands that he is Lucifer, but cannot yet explain the circular history or God's part in it.

5. The discovery of the serpent

Michael, now Lucifer, experiences Hell as profound isolation. His demonic appearance reflects his torment, but his desire to end suffering survives.

In the depths, he recognizes the same divine power he knew in Heaven sustaining the prison around him. The ice reveals its serpentine source: the God he served maintains both Heaven and Hell. What he believed was a war against an independent evil belongs to an arrangement upheld by God himself.

Lucifer concludes that the serpent is the true cause of creation's suffering. He has been attacking a sufferer within the system while serving the power responsible for it.

He decides to rise against God. He believes that defeating the serpent will free everyone from this arrangement. He does not yet understand what will happen when the power maintaining separation is removed.

6. The gathering of Hell

Lucifer turns to the hordes. They distrust him when he reveals that he is Michael, their former enemy. He earns their attention through his knowledge of Heaven and its defences, then gives them a reason to believe victory is possible.

Heaven has no Michael waiting to oppose them. Michael is standing among them.

He offers liberation from the power that sustains their torment. Some follow because they want freedom, others because they want revenge, and others because they cannot bear Hell any longer. Their motives differ, but they share a credible opportunity.

The guardian who descended to end suffering now leads Hell's forces toward Heaven with the same purpose.

7. The defeat of God

Lucifer's knowledge and Michael's absence allow the invasion to reach the celestial court. Heaven's defenders resist, believing they are protecting creation. Lucifer confronts those he once stood beside, and the battle brings the suffering he originally hoped to prevent.

He defeats God and shatters the divine disguise. The serpent is exposed before the assembled angels. The power sustaining the separation of the realms is broken.

As Lucifer's demonic appearance falls away, Michael stands revealed again. The angels recognize their brother. They remember his goodness and his determination to protect them, and understand that the demon who led the assault was Michael himself.

Believing he has freed them from the true devil, they accept him as their ruler. Michael believes he can finally give creation the peace he sought.

8. The crumbling of Heaven

For a brief interval, Heaven survives. Michael tends to the wounded and tries to restore what the war damaged. Then the boundaries of the realm begin to fail.

Frost appears in the celestial court. Heaven's familiar spaces open into Hell. The distinction between the two worlds weakens because the power that maintained it has been defeated. Their apparent separation gives way to the oneness beneath them.

Michael cannot prevent the collapse. His compassion remains, but he does not possess God's ability to keep the realms apart. Defeating the serpent has removed the structure on which their world depended.

There is still time before separation disappears completely. Michael uses the power gained through his victory to create a final refuge: Eden.

9. The lifeboat of Eden

Michael offers Eden as an escape for everyone. Those who enter leave their former identities and burdens behind, becoming inhabitants of a new world while Heaven crumbles around it.

But to experience this refuge fully, Michael must forget the reality beneath it. Remembering himself in Hell would prevent him from inhabiting Eden's apparent freedom. He surrenders that knowledge and becomes Adam.

Eve comes into being as his companion. Together they discover the garden, build a life, and love one another without remembering the conflict that made their refuge necessary. Their happiness is genuine as lived experience.

Eden allows enough separation for them to encounter each other, and enough connection for that encounter to become love. It is a pocket of happiness between absolute solitude and the suffering of the divided realms.

10. The return of knowledge

Eden cannot stop the collapse already underway. Small signs intrude upon its beauty: cold in the water, a trace of frost, a familiar shape Adam cannot place. Forgetting shelters its inhabitants from the knowledge of their situation, but cannot preserve the world indefinitely.

As oneness returns, the serpent begins to reappear. Its presence grows as Eden loses coherence. Adam's innocence leaves him unable to recognize it or understand what it offers.

The serpent approaches Eve with the fruit, presenting knowledge as a gift. Through her, the fruit reaches Adam. He accepts it in trust.

At the bite, his buried memories return and the garden begins to disintegrate openly. The fruit marks the revelation of a collapse that would have happened regardless. It gives the return of knowledge a visible moment.

11. Eve turns to dust

Eden crumbles around Adam. He reaches for Eve, but she turns to dust before him. The refuge, its inhabitants, and the life they shared dissolve into oneness.

Lucifer is alone in Hell again, in his demonic form. He remembers being Michael and Adam, and remembers loving Eve. Oneness is absolute solitude: no other being exists independently anywhere in creation. Hell is both the place he experiences and the condition of being all alone.

The restoration of oneness also restores God. From that unity, the power of separation re-forms and begins creating the divided world again. Heaven and Hell return, with the beings and boundaries that give them their apparent existence.

Lucifer does not yet understand this relationship. He experiences God's return as the triumph of the enemy who has taken Eve from him. He determines to conquer Heaven again, recover the power to recreate their refuge, and find her once more.

12. The return to the opening

Lucifer rallies Hell's hordes and rises toward Heaven. He has defeated God before. He knows Heaven's defences, and believes there is still no Michael to stop him.

At the celestial court, Michael stands waiting. Beside him is the angel with the serpentine smile.

This is the exact encounter that opened the film. Lucifer's appearance, Michael's position, the watching angel, and the events of the confrontation are the same. We now reach them through Lucifer's experience.

He sees his own earlier self standing outside him, unaware of becoming the demon he faces. The smiling angel reveals the serpent's presence in another form. Lucifer begins to understand the creation that has made this impossible meeting possible.

13. The understanding and the fall

Lucifer understands what God is. The serpent embodies the mechanism by which one consciousness experiences itself as apparently separate beings, worlds, and moments. Michael can stand over there while Lucifer stands over here because creation gives the same consciousness different perspectives and memories.

His victory over God genuinely destroyed the power maintaining separation. That destruction brought back oneness; the restoration of oneness restored God; and God recreated the world of separation, including Michael as he was before his descent. The world returns through a closed loop whose events produce one another.

God sustains the arrangement in which suffering occurs. Yet abolishing that arrangement returns Lucifer to the absolute solitude of Hell. His victories cannot give him permanent freedom from both conditions. The happiness he longs for exists in pockets such as Eden, where he can experience another person and love her.

To become Adam and find Eve again, he must accept the creation that makes their encounter possible, including the forgetting that allows him to live it fully.

During the battle, Lucifer recognizes Michael's love for the innocent and feels compassion for the suffering ahead of him. He sees the self who will descend, discover the serpent, rise against God, and create Eden. He understands why this journey must continue.

At the decisive moment, he permits the opening Michael needs.

"We are the same, you and I..."

Michael hears a claim of shared nature or a warning that he too could fall. He does not understand the words literally. Lucifer knows he will misunderstand and does not try to force the complete revelation upon him. Michael's uncertainty is one of the causes that will carry him into Hell.

Michael delivers the blow. Lucifer falls.

We now remain with him through the descent the opening left behind. His demonic form is lit by a radiance that expresses understanding and compassion. His sorrow for Eve remains, accompanied by the memory of the life they shared and the knowledge that he will find her again as Adam.

As he falls, the words return:

In the beginning was the Word.

In the beginning was the Lie.

In the beginning was the Truth.

Above him, Heaven celebrates. Michael stands troubled by the victory he knows Lucifer allowed.

The title **hELL** appears. Its outer letters burn away, leaving **EL**.

The loop closes.